

Recommend a Schedule That Works for Everyone

Recommend

OREO

Option Challenge

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Find out when each person can come, recommend one time with a reason and a comparison, and say who will have to change something.

- WHO** You work in the office with Siti. Mr. Tan wants a one-hour meeting next week about next year's price list, with Kumar (customers), Mei Ling (costs) and Ali (the website).
- SITUATION** Mr. Tan is free at only two times: Tuesday 10 to 11 a.m. or Thursday 4 to 5 p.m. Each of the other three has one plan next week. The plans are in the box below.
- NEED** Mr. Tan needs Kumar, Mei Ling and Ali at this meeting. He wants your recommendation today, so that he can send the invite.
- GOAL** Recommend one of the two times, say why it fits, say who will have to change something, and answer Mr. Tan's questions.

Two times (Mr. Tan is free)

- Tuesday: 10 to 11 a.m.
- Thursday: 4 to 5 p.m.

Their plans next week

- Kumar: seeing a customer in Kluang on Tuesday at 11 · 1½ hours' drive
- Mei Ling: leaving at 4.30 on Thursday for her son's school concert
- Ali: at the warehouse in Kulai on Thursday morning · back by 2 p.m.

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: "So, for the price list meeting: Tuesday at ten or Thursday at four? Which one should I put in the invite?" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Siti's answer. Mark where each part starts.

We need Kumar, Mei Ling and Ali at this meeting, so I'd recommend Thursday at 4. The main reason is Kumar. On Tuesday he's seeing a customer in Kluang at 11, so he'll have to leave here by 9.30. Thursday is better for Kumar, and Ali will be back from Kulai by 2. Mei Ling is leaving at 4.30, but if she speaks first, she'll only miss half an hour. So overall, Thursday at 4 is the better time. Mei Ling will just need to give her part first.

O

NEED · RECOMMEND

R

REASON

E

COMPARE · WHO CHANGES

O

RECOMMENDATION AGAIN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Ali recommends a time to update every computer in the office. Order: Recommend → Reason → Compare → Again.

- ☐ So if Kumar sends his last orders before 4, Friday is the better time.
- ☐ Monday morning is easier for me, but Mei Ling will be paying the suppliers then.
- ☐ The main reason is that Friday afternoon is our quietest time, because most orders come in the morning.
- ☐ Nobody can work during the two-hour update, so I'd recommend Friday from 4 to 6.

Write the letter: **O** = Need · recommend · **R** = Reason · **E** = Compare · who changes · **O** = Recommendation again

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

ASK ABOUT THEIR WEEK

- ☐ When are you free next week?
- ☐ Are you free on ... at ...?
- ☐ Is there a day you can't come?

SAY WHAT FITS

- ☐ ... is free all afternoon.
- ☐ ... will be back by ...
- ☐ It fits everyone except ...

COMPARE THE TIMES

- ☐ ... is better than ... for ...
- ☐ ... is easier, because ...
- ☐ On ..., ... will be ...

RECOMMEND

- ☐ We need ..., so I'd recommend ...
- ☐ I think we should meet on ...
- ☐ It may be better to ...
- ☐ ... is the better time.

SAY WHAT HAS TO CHANGE

- ☐ If ..., everyone can come.
 - ☐ ... will just need to ...
 - ☐ Could you ... instead?
 - ☐ ... will miss the first / last ...
-

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. Kumar is seeing a customer in Kluang at 11. [or / so / because] He'll have to leave the office by 9.30.

2. Thursday is better for Kumar. [so / but / if] Mei Ling is leaving at 4.30.

3. I'd recommend Thursday. [so / but / because] Ali will be free then too.

4. Mei Ling speaks first. [or / because / If ...] She'll only miss the last half hour.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. On Tuesday, Kumar _____ a customer in Kluang. (A plan already in the diary)

☐ seeing

☐ is seeing

☐ is see

2. Ali _____ back from Kulai by 2 p.m. (What will happen)

☐ will be

☐ will is

☐ will being

3. If Mei Ling _____ first, she'll only miss half an hour. (The if part)

☐ will speaks

☐ speaking

☐ speaks

4. Kumar _____ leave the office by 9.30 on Tuesday. (What someone must do)

☐ will have to

☐ will to have

☐ will has to

SLIDE 09 Plans · will have to · if · -er than

To recommend a time, say what people are doing, what someone will have to do, the change with if ... will, and compare the two times.

On Tuesday, Kumar **is seeing** a customer in Kluang.

He **will have to** leave the office by 9.30.

If Mei Ling **speaks** first, she'll only miss half an hour.

Thursday is **better** for Kumar. It's **easier than** Tuesday.

SLIDE 10 Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.



NEED · RECOMMEND

We need ..., so I'd recommend ...



REASON

The main reason is ... On ..., ... will ...



COMPARE · WHO CHANGES

... is better for ..., but ... If ..., ...



RECOMMENDATION AGAIN

So overall, ... is the better time. ... will just need to ...

SLIDE 11 **Option Challenge**

The recommender asks the listener about their week, recommends one of two times and says who will have to change what. The listener writes a note: the time, why it fits, and who changes what. The listener asks 'Why not the other time?'; the recommender answers in one or two sentences.

- 1. Round 1 (3:00): say your card number and the two times. Ask the listener about their week. Recommend one time.
- 2. Listener: say your plan when asked (if not asked, say it after) . Fill the note, then ask 'Why not the other time?'
- 3. Round 2 (2:00): line B moves one seat. Same card, new listener. Ask again; then shorter: time, why, who changes what.
- 4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed: the listener says their plan first. Workbook over. Then swap roles, rounds 1–3.

Card 1 · Training on the new claims app

Card 2 · Video call with a customer in Singapore

Card 3 · Welcome lunch for two new staff

Card 4 · Visiting a colleague in hospital

Listener's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card · asked me first?			
Time			
Why it fits			
Who changes what			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. What time will the meeting finish?
2. Who will have to change something?
3. When will you tell the others?

Start with: **It will finish at ... · ... will have to ... · I'll tell them ...**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

Your family is planning a dinner for your grandmother's 80th birthday next month: Saturday or Sunday, at 7 p.m. Your brother works in Singapore until 6 on Saturdays and needs about 2 hours to get home through the Causeway. Your sister is at a wedding lunch in Melaka on Sunday and will be back at about 7.30. Your grandmother goes to bed at 10. Recommend one day and say who has to change what.

We need ..., so I'd recommend ... · The main reason is ... · ... is better than ... for ... · If ..., everyone can come.

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

☐

Names what the meeting needs and proposes one time.

☐

Compares the two times and says why the choice fits each person.

☐

Says who will have to change something, and what they will do.

SLIDE 15 Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Need and one time

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Comparing the two times

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Who changes what

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Useful expressions

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Confidence

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11 **Listener cards: fold or cut**

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · Training on the new claims app

You are Siti. When asked, say: 'On Monday I'm interviewing a new driver from 2 to 2.30.' Fill the note, then ask: 'Why not the other time?'

Card 2 · Video call with a customer in Singapore

You are Ali. You set up the call. When asked, say: 'Next Tuesday I'm on half-day leave in the morning. It's already approved in the HR app.' Fill the note, then ask: 'Why not the other time?'

Card 3 · Welcome lunch for two new staff

You are Mei Ling. When asked, say: 'On Wednesday I must pay the suppliers online before 1.30.' Fill the note, then ask: 'Why not the other time?'

Card 4 · Visiting a colleague in hospital

You are Kumar. When asked, say: 'On Saturday I'm driving my parents to KL. I'm leaving at 9 a.m.' Fill the note, then ask: 'Why not the other time?'

SLIDE 11 Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 • Training on the new claims app

Ali can give a one-hour training on the claims app: Monday at 2 p.m. or Wednesday at 10 a.m. Kumar, Mei Ling and Siti must all go. Kumar is at a KL trade fair all day on Wednesday. Mei Ling is at the bank on Monday at 4. Ask Siti.

Card 2 • Video call with a customer in Singapore

A customer can do a one-hour video call: Tuesday at 9 a.m. or Friday at 3 p.m. Kumar, Mei Ling and Ali must all join. Kumar is seeing another customer on Friday at 10. Mei Ling is at the bank on Friday from 2 to 3.30. Ask Ali.

Card 3 • Welcome lunch for two new staff

A welcome lunch, 1 to 2 p.m.: Wednesday or Thursday. Kumar, Mei Ling and Ali must all come. Kumar is at a factory in Pasir Gudang on Thursday until 1; the drive back is 30 minutes. Ali is free both days. Ask Mei Ling.

Card 4 • Visiting a colleague in hospital

You, Kumar and Ali want to visit a colleague in hospital. Visiting hours: 12 to 2 and 5 to 8 p.m. Thursday at 6.30 p.m. or Saturday at 12. You have a dentist appointment on Thursday at 6. Ali is free both days. Ask Kumar.